# FOREST TYPES AND FOREST RIGHTS ACT

**FOUR-VOCABULARY FIREWALL → MOISTURE-GRADIENT MAP → MOUNTAIN-ZONATION RAIL → LEGAL-CATEGORY MATRIX → COVER-RECORD DIVERGENCE → FRA PURPOSE GATE**

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

★ PRIMARY CORE FLOW · ◇ SUBORDINATE EXTRA · ★ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g2 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

## STAGE 00 FOUR-VOCABULARY FIREWALL

FOUR-VOCABULARY FIREWALL · FOREST TYPE · ECOLOGY, CLIMATE AND VEGETATION · LEGAL CATEGORY · RESERVED, PROTECTED OR VILLAGE FOREST · RECORDED FOREST AREA · GOVERNMENT FOREST RECORD · FOREST OR TREE COVER

| CORE CLAIM | MECHANISM | CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT |
|---|---|---|
| FOREST TYPE → ecology, climate and vegetation | RECORDED FOREST AREA → government forest record | RULE → never use one vocabulary as automatic proof of another |
| LEGAL CATEGORY → Reserved, Protected or Village Forest | FOREST OR TREE COVER → canopy measurement | MUST REMEMBER: Forest analysis must separate ecological forest type, canopy- based forest... |

**CORE CLAIM**
- FOREST TYPE → ecology, climate and vegetation
- LEGAL CATEGORY → Reserved, Protected or Village Forest

**MECHANISM**
- RECORDED FOREST AREA → government forest record
- FOREST OR TREE COVER → canopy measurement

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- RULE → never use one vocabulary as automatic proof of another
- MUST REMEMBER: Forest analysis must separate ecological forest type, canopy-based forest...

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → never use one vocabulary as automatic proof of another.**

01

## STAGE 01 MOISTURE-GRADIENT MAP

MOISTURE-GRADIENT MAP · VERY WET · TROPICAL WET EVERGREEN · SEASONAL MOISTURE · MOIST DECIDUOUS · DRIER SEASONAL CLIMATE · DRY DECIDUOUS · THORN AND DROUGHT-ADAPTED VEGETATION

VERY WET → tropical wet evergreen

TRANSITION → semi-evergreen → SEASONAL MOISTURE → moist deciduous → DRIER SEASONAL CLIMATE → dry deciduous

**CORE CLAIM**
- VERY WET → tropical wet evergreen
- TRANSITION → semi-evergreen

**MECHANISM**
- SEASONAL MOISTURE → moist deciduous
- DRIER SEASONAL CLIMATE → dry deciduous

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- ARIDITY → thorn and drought-adapted vegetation
- VERY WET → tropical wet evergreen

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: DRIER SEASONAL CLIMATE → dry deciduous; ARIDITY → thorn and drought-adapted vegetation.**

02

## STAGE 02 MOUNTAIN-ZONATION RAIL

MOUNTAIN-ZONATION RAIL · LOWER SLOPES · CLIMATE AND ASPECT CONDITION FOREST · MONTANE BELTS · CHANGING TEMPERATURE AND MOISTURE · UPPER TREE-LIMIT TRANSITION · VEGETATION ABOVE FOREST LIMIT · LOCAL EXPOSURE AND LAND USE MODIFY THE IDEAL SEQUENCE

LOWER SLOPES → climate and aspect condition forest

MONTANE BELTS → changing temperature and moisture → SUB-ALPINE → upper tree-limit transition → ALPINE → vegetation above forest limit

**CORE CLAIM**
- LOWER SLOPES → climate and aspect condition forest
- MONTANE BELTS → changing temperature and moisture

**MECHANISM**
- SUB-ALPINE → upper tree-limit transition
- ALPINE → vegetation above forest limit

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- CAUTION → local exposure and land use modify the ideal sequence
- LOWER SLOPES → climate and aspect condition forest

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CAUTION → local exposure and land use modify the ideal sequence.**

03

## STAGE 03 LEGAL-CATEGORY MATRIX

LEGAL-CATEGORY MATRIX · RESERVED FOREST · RESTRICTIVE PERMISSION PRESUMPTION · PROTECTED FOREST · DIFFERENT PERMISSION AND PROHIBITION STRUCTURE · VILLAGE FOREST · STATUTORY MANAGEMENT CATEGORY · UNCLASSED FOREST

| CORE CLAIM | MECHANISM | CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT |
|---|---|---|
| RESERVED FOREST → restrictive permission presumption | VILLAGE FOREST → statutory management category | NONE → an ecological type or canopy-density class |
| PROTECTED FOREST → different permission and prohibition structure | UNCLASSED FOREST → verify record and applicable legal basis | RESERVED FOREST → restrictive permission presumption |

**CORE CLAIM**
- RESERVED FOREST → restrictive permission presumption
- PROTECTED FOREST → different permission and prohibition structure

**MECHANISM**
- VILLAGE FOREST → statutory management category
- UNCLASSED FOREST → verify record and applicable legal basis

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- NONE → an ecological type or canopy-density class
- RESERVED FOREST → restrictive permission presumption

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NONE → an ecological type or canopy-density class.**

04

## STAGE 04 COVER-RECORD DIVERGENCE

COVER-RECORD DIVERGENCE · RECORDED FOREST WITH LOW CANOPY · LEGAL RECORD CAN REMAIN · PLANTATION OR ORCHARD WITH CANOPY · MAY ENTER COVER MEASUREMENT · FOREST COVER · REMOTE-SENSING CRITERION · TREE COVER

| CORE CLAIM | MECHANISM | CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT |
|---|---|---|
| RECORDED FOREST WITH LOW CANOPY → legal record can remain | FOREST COVER → remote-sensing criterion | RESULT → area figures answer different questions |
| PLANTATION OR ORCHARD WITH CANOPY → may enter cover measurement | TREE COVER → separate measurement category | RECORDED FOREST WITH LOW CANOPY → legal record can remain |

**CORE CLAIM**
- RECORDED FOREST WITH LOW CANOPY → legal record can remain
- PLANTATION OR ORCHARD WITH CANOPY → may enter cover measurement

**MECHANISM**
- FOREST COVER → remote-sensing criterion
- TREE COVER → separate measurement category

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- RESULT → area figures answer different questions
- RECORDED FOREST WITH LOW CANOPY → legal record can remain

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: PLANTATION OR ORCHARD WITH CANOPY → may enter cover measurement.**

05

## STAGE 05 FRA PURPOSE GATE

FRA PURPOSE GATE · PAST EXCLUSION · HISTORICAL INJUSTICE · ELIGIBLE FOREST DWELLER · STATUTORY CLAIMANT CATEGORY · RIGHT CLAIM · EVIDENCE AND PROCEDURE · DEFINED RIGHT AND TITLE

PAST EXCLUSION → historical injustice → ELIGIBLE FOREST DWELLER → statutory claimant category → RIGHT CLAIM → evidence and procedure → RECOGNITION → defined right and title → NO BLANKET TRANSFER → State governance framework continues

**CORE CLAIM**
- PAST EXCLUSION → historical injustice
- ELIGIBLE FOREST DWELLER → statutory claimant category

**MECHANISM**
- RIGHT CLAIM → evidence and procedure
- RECOGNITION → defined right and title

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- NO BLANKET TRANSFER → State governance framework continues
- PAST EXCLUSION → historical injustice

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NO BLANKET TRANSFER → State governance framework continues.**

06

## STAGE 06 ELIGIBILITY DECISION TREE

ELIGIBILITY DECISION TREE · FOREST-DWELLING SCHEDULED TRIBE OR OTFD · BEFORE 13 DECEMBER 2005 · OTFD ONLY · THREE GENERATIONS OR 75 YEARS PLUS DEPENDENCE · APPLY STATUTORY AND RULES-BASED FORMS · ELIGIBILITY CLAIM STILL REQUIRES VERIFICATION

CLAIMANT → forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribe or OTFD

OCCUPATION → before 13 December 2005 → OTFD ONLY → three generations or 75 years plus dependence → EVIDENCE → apply statutory and Rules-based forms

**CORE CLAIM**
- CLAIMANT → forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribe or OTFD
- OCCUPATION → before 13 December 2005

**MECHANISM**
- OTFD ONLY → three generations or 75 years plus dependence
- EVIDENCE → apply statutory and Rules-based forms

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- PROCEDURE → eligibility claim still requires verification
- CLAIMANT → forest-dwelling Scheduled Tribe or OTFD

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: OTFD ONLY → three generations or 75 years plus dependence.**

07

## STAGE 07 RIGHTS MATRIX

RIGHTS MATRIX · PRIOR HABITATION OR SELF-CULTIVATION UNDER ACTUAL OCCUPATION · COMMUNITY RIGHTS · CUSTOMARY ACCESS, GRAZING, WATER AND MFP · CFR RIGHT · PROTECT, REGENERATE, CONSERVE AND MANAGE RESOURCE · HABITAT RIGHT · PVTG OR PRE-AGRICULTURAL COMMUNITY ROUTE

| CORE CLAIM | MECHANISM | CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT |
|---|---|---|
| IFR → prior habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation | CFR RIGHT → protect, regenerate, conserve and manage resource | RULE → right categories have different holders and content |
| COMMUNITY RIGHTS → customary access, grazing, water and MFP | HABITAT RIGHT → PVTG or pre-agricultural community route | IFR → prior habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation |

**CORE CLAIM**
- IFR → prior habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation
- COMMUNITY RIGHTS → customary access, grazing, water and MFP

**MECHANISM**
- CFR RIGHT → protect, regenerate, conserve and manage resource
- HABITAT RIGHT → PVTG or pre-agricultural community route

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- RULE → right categories have different holders and content
- IFR → prior habitation or self-cultivation under actual occupation

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: RULE → right categories have different holders and content.**

08

## STAGE 08 RECOGNITION PROCEDURE

RECOGNITION PROCEDURE · GRAM SABHA · INITIATE, RECEIVE AND VERIFY CLAIMS · SCRUTINISE AND HEAR THE INTERMEDIATE CLAIM STAGE · FINAL DISTRICT-LEVEL DECISION · TITLE OR REASONED REJECTION · OUTCOME AFTER PROCEDURE · NO ASSUMPTION

GRAM SABHA → initiate, receive and verify claims → SDLC → scrutinise and hear the intermediate claim stage → DLC → final district-level decision → TITLE OR REASONED REJECTION → outcome after procedure → NO ASSUMPTION → filing or recommendation is not conferment

**CORE CLAIM**
- GRAM SABHA → initiate, receive and verify claims
- SDLC → scrutinise and hear the intermediate claim stage

**MECHANISM**
- DLC → final district-level decision
- TITLE OR REASONED REJECTION → outcome after procedure

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- NO ASSUMPTION → filing or recommendation is not conferment
- GRAM SABHA → initiate, receive and verify claims

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: NO ASSUMPTION → filing or recommendation is not conferment.**

09

## STAGE 09 SAFEGUARD AND FACILITY GATE

SAFEGUARD AND FACILITY GATE · SECTION 4(5) · NO EVICTION BEFORE RECOGNITION PROCESS COMPLETES · SAFEGUARD DOES NOT AUTOMATICALLY APPROVE EVERY CLAIM · SECTION 3(2) · SPECIFIED COMMUNITY FACILITIES ONLY · RETAIN AREA, TREE AND GRAM SABHA LIMITS FROM THE · NO EXTENSION

SECTION 4(5) → no eviction before recognition process completes → LIMIT → safeguard does not automatically approve every claim → SECTION 3(2) → specified community facilities only → CONDITIONS → retain area, tree and Gram Sabha limits from the owner → NO EXTENSION → not a general non-forest-use exemption

**CORE CLAIM**
- SECTION 4(5) → no eviction before recognition process completes
- LIMIT → safeguard does not automatically approve every claim

**MECHANISM**
- SECTION 3(2) → specified community facilities only
- CONDITIONS → retain area, tree and Gram Sabha limits from the owner

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- NO EXTENSION → not a general non-forest-use exemption
- CLOSE DISTINCTION: Forest cover is not recorded forest area, legal forest is not...

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: CLOSE DISTINCTION: Forest cover is not recorded forest area, legal forest is not.**

10

## STAGE 10 RIGHTS-CONSERVATION BRIDGE

RIGHTS-CONSERVATION BRIDGE · RECOGNISED TENURE · STRONGER STEWARDSHIP INCENTIVE MAY FOLLOW · CFR INSTITUTION · COMMUNITY MANAGEMENT AUTHORITY · ECOLOGICAL, TECHNICAL AND LIVELIHOOD CAPACITY · FOREST CONDITION AND DISTRIBUTIONAL OUTCOMES · TITLE IS AN INPUT, NOT AUTOMATIC ECOLOGICAL SUCCESS

RECOGNISED TENURE → stronger stewardship incentive may follow → CFR INSTITUTION → community management authority → SUPPORT → ecological, technical and livelihood capacity → MONITOR → forest condition and distributional outcomes → QUALIFY → title is an input, not automatic ecological success

**CORE CLAIM**
- RECOGNISED TENURE → stronger stewardship incentive may follow
- CFR INSTITUTION → community management authority

**MECHANISM**
- SUPPORT → ecological, technical and livelihood capacity
- MONITOR → forest condition and distributional outcomes

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- QUALIFY → title is an input, not automatic ecological success
- EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: State dataset or legal definition, canopy...

**MECHANISM / VERDICT —** EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: State dataset or legal definition, canopy...

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: EVIDENCE LIMIT: MECHANISM / STATUS / CAUSATION: State dataset or legal definition, canopy.**

11

## STAGE 11 PYQ ANSWER SPINE

PYQ ANSWER SPINE · TYPE, LEGAL CATEGORY, RECORD, COVER OR RIGHT · CLAIMANT, RIGHT HOLDER AND PROCEDURE · GRAM SABHA, SDLC AND DLC · BAMBOO, HABITAT, FOREST TYPE, MIYAWAKI OR RESOURCE DEMAND · DATED DATA AND OBJECTIVE KEYS REMAIN SOURCE-BOUNDED

CLASSIFY → type, legal category, record, cover or right → DEFINE → claimant, right holder and procedure → TRACE → Gram Sabha, SDLC and DLC → APPLY → bamboo, habitat, forest type, Miyawaki or resource demand → QUALIFY → dated data and objective keys remain source-bounded

**CORE CLAIM**
- CLASSIFY → type, legal category, record, cover or right
- DEFINE → claimant, right holder and procedure

**MECHANISM**
- TRACE → Gram Sabha, SDLC and DLC
- APPLY → bamboo, habitat, forest type, Miyawaki or resource demand

**CONSEQUENCE / LIMIT**
- QUALIFY → dated data and objective keys remain source-bounded
- CLASSIFY → type, legal category, record, cover or right

**ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: QUALIFY → dated data and objective keys remain source-bounded.**

E

## EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT · STRUCTURAL TENSION · THE WILDLIFE PROTECTION ACT'S CORE/CRITICAL-HABITAT RELOCATION · DOCUMENTED FRICTION · IN VARIOUS PROTECTED-AREA LANDSCAPES, RELOCATION PROCESSES · BALANCED FRAMING FOR MAINS · PRESENT THIS NOT AS ONE LAW BEING "CORRECT" AND · THE CHAMPION-SETH-STYLE CLASSIFICATION (USED AS THE STANDARD REFERENCE FRAMEWORK)

**OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH**
- CAUTION: Structural tension: the Wildlife Protection Act's core/critical-habitat relocation
- CAUTION: Documented friction: in various protected-area landscapes, relocation processes
- CAUTION: Balanced framing for Mains: present this not as one law being "correct" and the
- CAUTION: The Champion-Seth-style classification (used as the standard reference framework) is

**ADVANCED DEBATE**
- CAUTION: FSI's canopy-density- based forest-cover measurement (very dense, moderately dense, open
- CAUTION: FRA claims-processing statistics (total claims filed, titles granted, rejection rates)
- CAUTION: CFR-area statistics (total community forest resource area formally vested) are
- CAUTION: Assessing whether CFR rights have measurably improved forest-conservation outcomes

**LEGACY / NUANCE**
- The FRA's claims process runs through Gram Sabha, Sub-Divisional Level Committee and
- Community Forest Resource (CFR) rights are distinct from Community Rights and Individual
- High claim-rejection rates in several states have been linked primarily to demanding
- FSI's canopy-density-based forest-cover categories (very dense/moderately dense/open

**OPTIONAL STATUS —** This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels